From a count to a claim

Observe

Record the place, dates and unit of measurement. For example, count the same bins over five lunch breaks and record the number of students present.

Compare

A school counted 80 cups with 400 students present and later counted 60 with 250 students present. The totals fell, but the rates rose from 20 to 24 cups per 100 students.

Write cautiously

A defensible conclusion reports the measure and its limitation. Try: 'The total fell, but fewer students attended. We need a comparable week before judging the change.'

Plan the next observation

Choose a location, schedule and denominator for your own school trial. Write one conditional prediction and a sentence describing what could challenge it.